

Instructor: ..... Date: .....

Learner: ..... Regional Branch: .....

Program: ..... Center: .....

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### Let's Start!

We have a small problem ... What is it?



### Learning Outcome

Accurately explain information about interests, hobbies, and preferences in communicative situations.

### Can Do Statements

- I can talk about problems and solutions.
- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can make suggestions.

### Ask your partner:

- What kind of problems do you have at school/work/home?
- How do you solve them?





## Let's Explore!

It's Sally's first day at work. What does she do?



*Instructions: Read the text aloud.*

**Clerk:** Hi, Sally. How are you?  
**Sally:** I'm nervous. It's my first day at work.  
**Clerk:** Don't worry. First, we have a small problem.  
**Sally:** Oh, what's that?  
**Clerk:** There is a new delivery, a stack of graphic novels, but they're a mess.  
**Sally:** How would you like me to organize them? By title or by year?  
**Clerk:** Let's organize them alphabetically by title. That's usually the best solution.  
**Sally:** Sounds like a great idea.  
**Clerk:** So, what are your hobbies?  
**Sally:** Well, I love to read comics, of course.  
**Clerk:** Me too.  
**Sally:** I'm learning to speak Spanish.  
**Clerk:** That sounds hard. I prefer to eat Spanish food.  
**Sally:** I want to learn to make Spanish food! It's so delicious.  
**Clerk:** You should cook for me!  
**Sally:** Sounds good.



## Let's Practice!

Organize them by title!

*Instructions: Draw a line from the first part of the statement on the left to the second part on the right.*

- |                       |                      |
|-----------------------|----------------------|
| 1. There is a         | by year?             |
| 2. It's my first      | me to organize them? |
| 3. A stack of         | graphic novels.      |
| 4. How would you like | day at work.         |
| 5. By title or        | new delivery.        |



## Let's Practice!

That sounds hard!

*Instructions: Find and fix the mistake. Each sentence has 1 mistake.*

1. First, we are a small problem.
2. Oh, what's there?
3. It's organize them alphabetically.
4. That's usually the good solution.





## Extension Activity

Let's Role Play! Practice talking about problems and solutions at work.

*Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- Create a short dialogue with a partner about a problem at a workplace.
- Read each role below.
- Choose a role and practice it with your partner.
- Change roles and practice again.

### Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue about a situation in a work setting.

☐ ☐

I make suggestions.

☐ ☐

I talk about problems and solutions.

☐ ☐

|                |                                                                                                                                           |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Role 1:</b> | It is your first day at work. You are nervous. The clerk tells you about a problem. You make a suggestion to help.                        |
| <b>Role 2:</b> | You are a clerk at a bookstore. You have a small problem. The books are not organized. Ask the new clerk to organize them alphabetically. |



## Target Words

- **delivery** (noun): something that a person takes to another place  
e.g. There is a delivery of new books.
- **stack** (noun): a group of things that are put on top of one another  
e.g. There is a stack of new books.
- **solution** (noun): something that helps a situation  
e.g. That's a good solution.
- **problem** (noun): something that is difficult to deal with  
e.g. We have a small problem.
- **to organize** (verb): to put things in order  
e.g. Please organize the books.
- **alphabetically** (adverb): to put things in the order of the alphabet  
e.g. Please organize the books alphabetically.





## Learning Points

### Talking About Problems at Work

When you talk about problems at work, you can use Present Simple and phrases like:

| To start                            | To reply                    |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| <i>We have a small problem.</i>     | <i>Oh, what is it?</i>      |
| <i>There is a misunderstanding.</i> | <i>Oh, what is it?</i>      |
| <i>We have an issue.</i>            | <i>What's the issue?</i>    |
| <i>Can we discuss this?</i>         | <i>Of course.</i>           |
| <i>What do you think?</i>           | <i>Let's talk about it.</i> |

### Examples:

• **Tom:** *We have a small problem.*

**Cathy:** *Oh, what is it?*

**Tom:** *There is a misunderstanding in the e-mail.*

